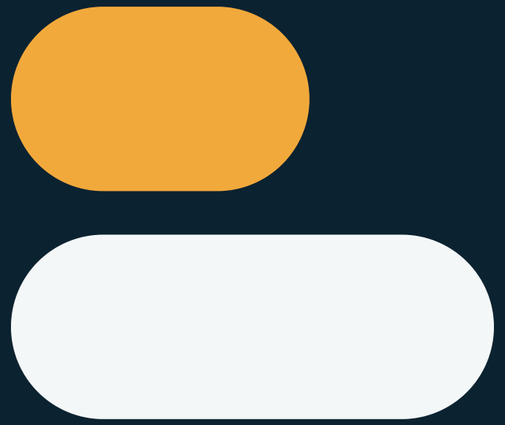


Berth Studio

Logo case study

Berth Studio, open source database and API client

October 2026

BRIEF

One app for databases and APIs

Berth Studio is an open source desktop app for backend engineers. It combines a database client for PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Supabase and Firebase with an API client and an ERD canvas, all in one window.

People open it many times a day, often on a screen full of tabs and terminals. The logo has to be recognisable at a glance in the macOS Dock, in a browser tab and in a GitHub README.

Goals for the logo

1. **Simple.** Two shapes and two colours, nothing more.
2. **Clear at 16 px.** The size of a favicon or a small sidebar icon.
3. **A story.** Tied to the name Berth and to what the app does.
4. **Measured.** Every proportion comes from the golden ratio, so it is easy to redraw exactly.

NAME

Berth: where a ship ties up

A *berth* is the slot in a harbour where a ship is moored. Every ship has its own place, orderly and safe.

Connections in Berth Studio work the same way. Every database and API has its own place, with separate profiles for dev, staging and prod, and secrets kept safe in the keychain.



Top pill, amber

The API. Lighter and shorter, like requests that come and go.

Bottom pill, navy

The database. Longer and heavier, the foundation everything rests on.

The gap between them

The pier. A small space that separates and joins the two, and turns the pair into the silhouette of a B.

EXPLORATION

From complicated to simple



Round 1 · Letter B and a dot

Rejected. Two bowls of different sizes made it lopsided, and the dot looked stuck.



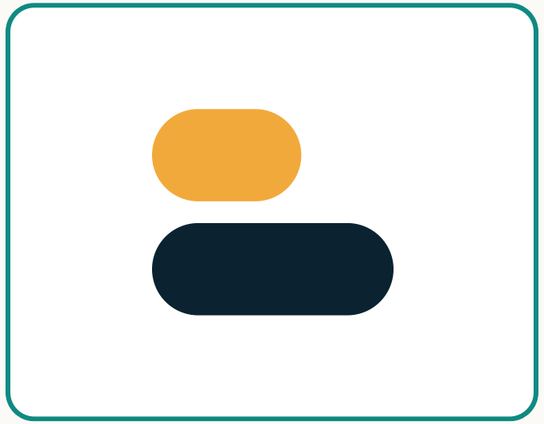
A · Slip

A berth seen from above. Clear, but easily read as a magnet or a cup.



B · Porthole b

Tidy as a letter, but letters in circles are everywhere, so it lacks character.



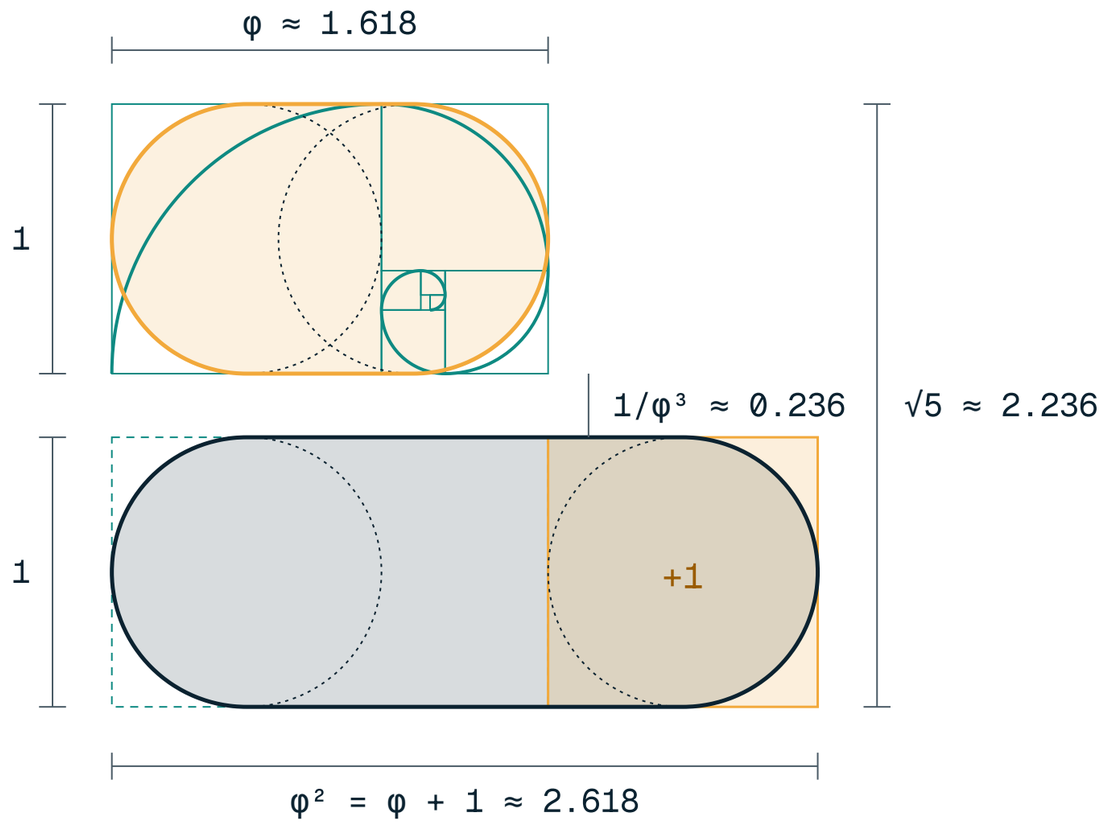
C · Two berths

Chosen. Just two shapes, read at once as a B, as two berths and as layers of data.

The feedback on round one was short: "not simple, and a bit odd". Round two dropped every curve and detail and started again from two pills.

CONSTRUCTION

The golden ratio, from unit to silhouette



1 · Unit

The height of one pill is one unit. Its ends are half circles with a diameter of 1.

2 · Top pill = ϕ

Its length is ϕ, so its frame is a golden rectangle. The golden spiral fits inside.

3 · Bottom pill = ϕ + 1

The top shape plus one unit square. Because $\phi + 1 = \phi^2$, the two pills are exactly 1 : ϕ.

4 · Gap = 1/ϕ³

This gap makes the total height exactly √5, the same number that defines $\phi = (1 + \sqrt{5}) / 2$.

PROPORTIONS

Every measurement in one table

ELEMENT	FORMULA	VALUE
Pill height, unit h	1	1.000
Corner radius	h / 2	0.500
Top pill length	φ	1.618
Bottom pill length	φ² = φ + 1	2.618
Gap	1 / φ³	0.236
Logo width	φ²	2.618
Logo height	2 + 1/φ³ = √5	2.236
Top : bottom ratio	1 : φ	1 : 1.618

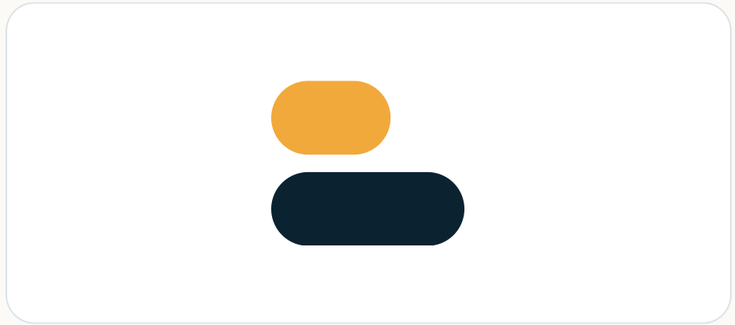
Every version of the logo, from the 16 px icon to the cover of this document, uses exactly these proportions. To redraw the logo, follow this table.

The corner radius is always half the pill height, so the ends stay perfectly round at any size.

FINAL LOGO

Berth Studio

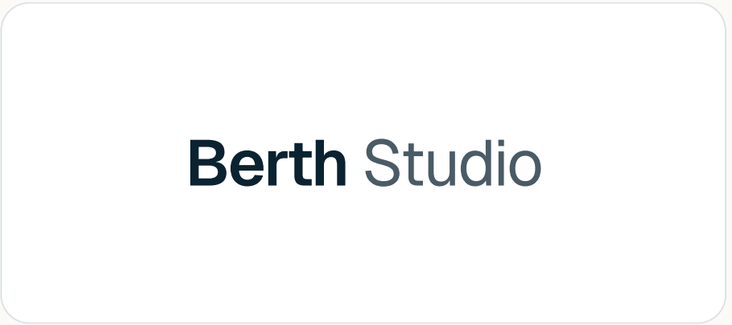




Mark



Stacked

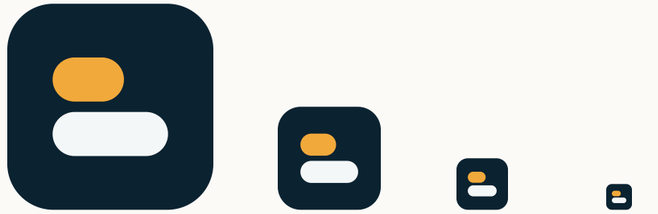


Wordmark

APP ICON

In the Dock, the sidebar and the browser tab





On the icon the bottom pill turns mist so it stands out on navy. The mark takes 56% of the icon width and sits exactly in the centre. At 16 px the two pills are still clearly apart.

COLOUR

Harbor navy and signal amber



Harbor navy

#0B2230
RGB 11 34 48

Primary colour. The database pill, the wordmark and the icon background.



Signal amber

#F2A93B
RGB 242 169 59

Accent. The API pill and key highlights only.



Tide teal

#0E8A82
RGB 14 138 130

The accent inside the app: focus, selection, primary buttons.

Mist

#F4F7F8
RGB 244 247 248

Light backgrounds, and the bottom pill on navy.



Proportion of use: 60 mist, 25 navy, 10 teal, 5 amber. Amber is used least on purpose, so it keeps drawing the eye.

TYPOGRAPHY

Geist for words, Geist Mono for data

Aa

0123

Geist

The wordmark and the whole UI. Geometric and neutral, so the pills stay the star. "Berth" in 600, "Studio" in 400.

Regular 400 **Medium 500** **Semibold 600**

Geist Mono

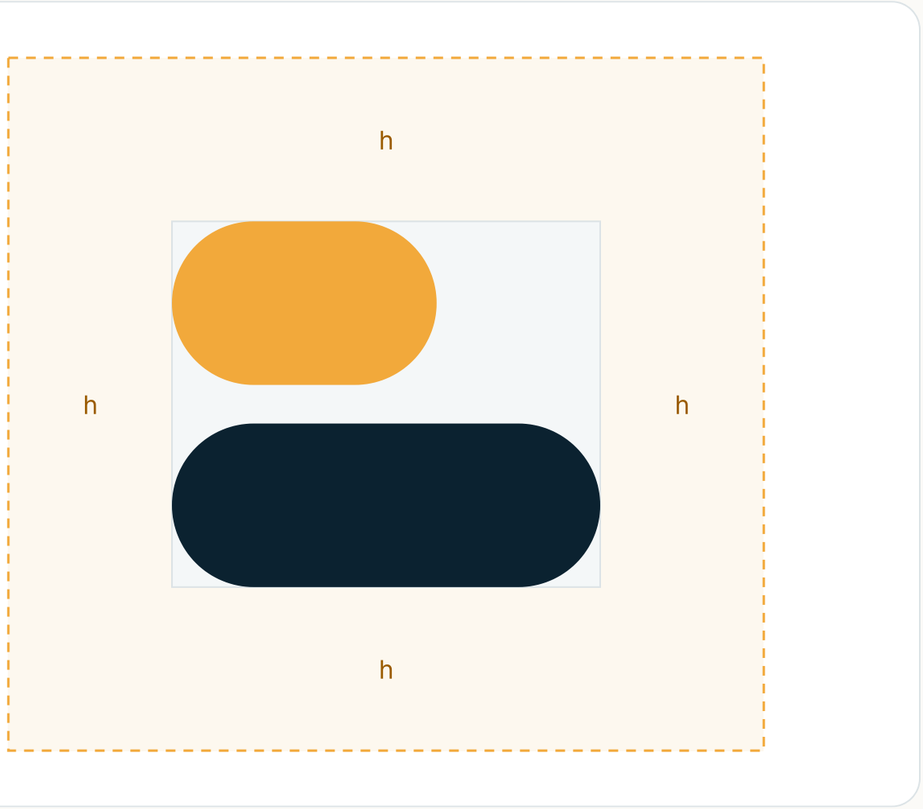
Queries, grid values and code. Its digits share one width, so columns stay aligned.

```
SELECT id, email FROM users
WHERE plan = 'pro'
LIMIT 50;
```

Both fonts use the SIL Open Font License, so they are safe for an open source project.

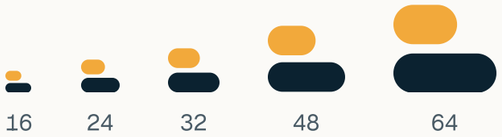
USAGE

Clear space and minimum size



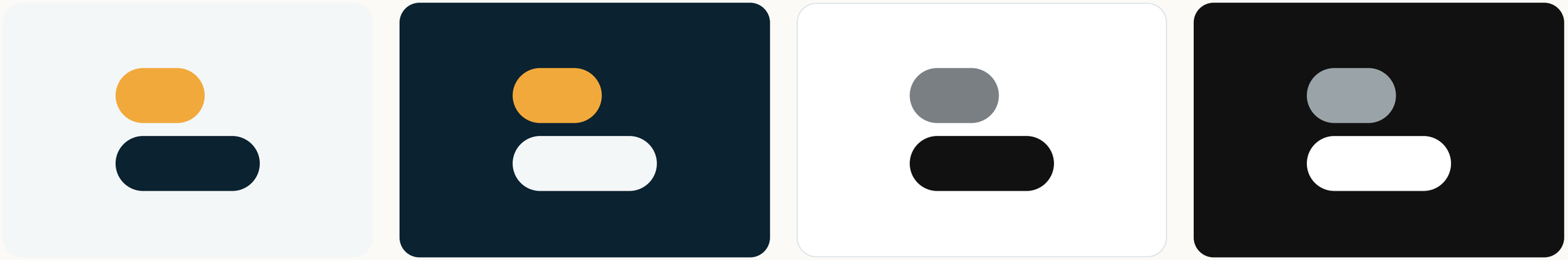
Clear space. Keep at least one pill height, h, empty on every side of the logo. No text or other element may enter it.

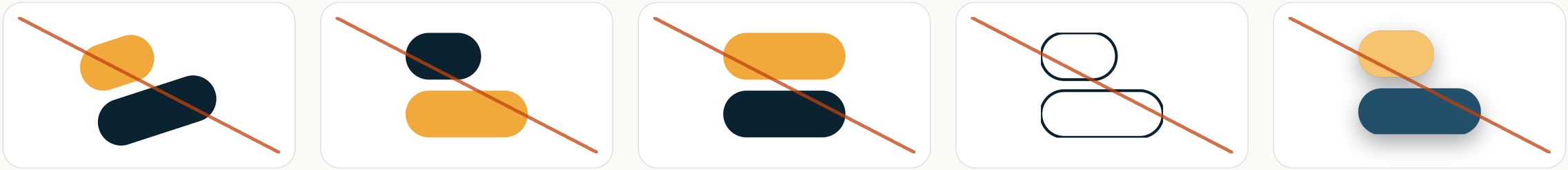
Minimum size. The mark is at least 16 px, the horizontal lockup at least 96 px wide. Below that, use the mark on its own.



VARIATIONS

On light, dark and one colour





Don't rotate

Don't swap colours

Don't change proportions

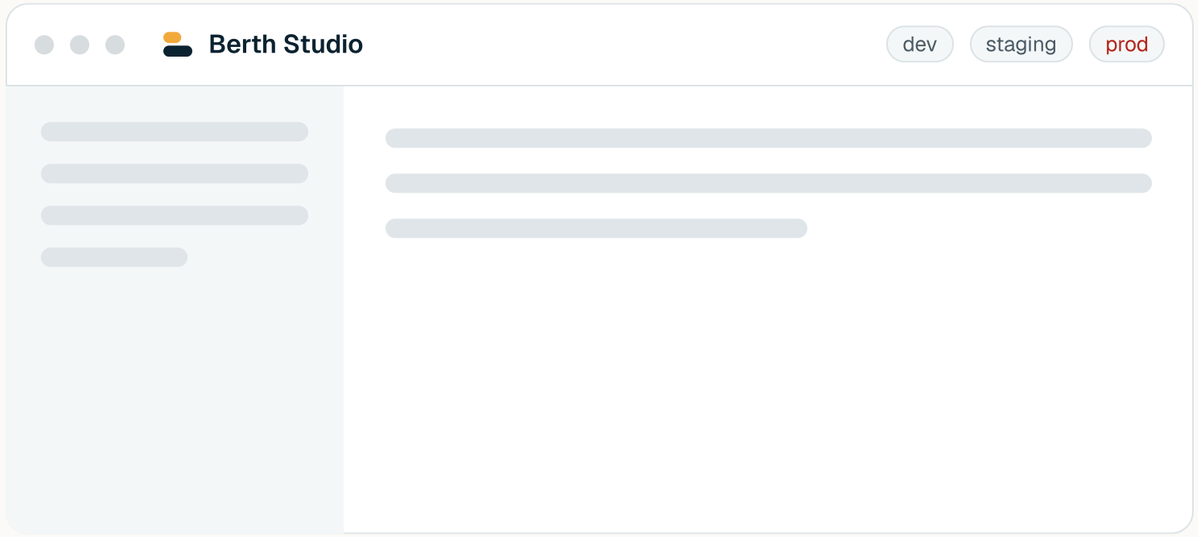
Don't outline

Don't add effects

IN USE

The logo where it works

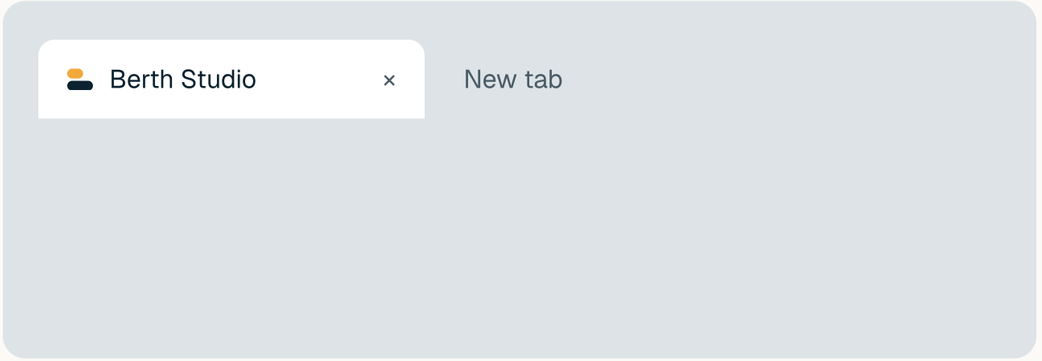


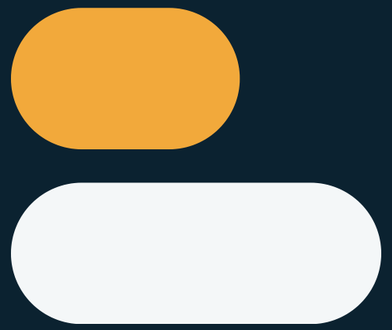


Berth Studio

One app for your databases and your APIs.

English · Bahasa Indonesia · 简体中文 · 日本語 · العربية · Русский





Two pills. Two colours. One ratio.

B

Two stacked pills read as the letter B, and stay clear at 16 px.

API + DB

Amber for the API, navy for the database, and the gap between them as the pier.

ϕ

Top pill ϕ, bottom pill ϕ^2, gap $1/\phi^3$, total height $\sqrt{5}$.